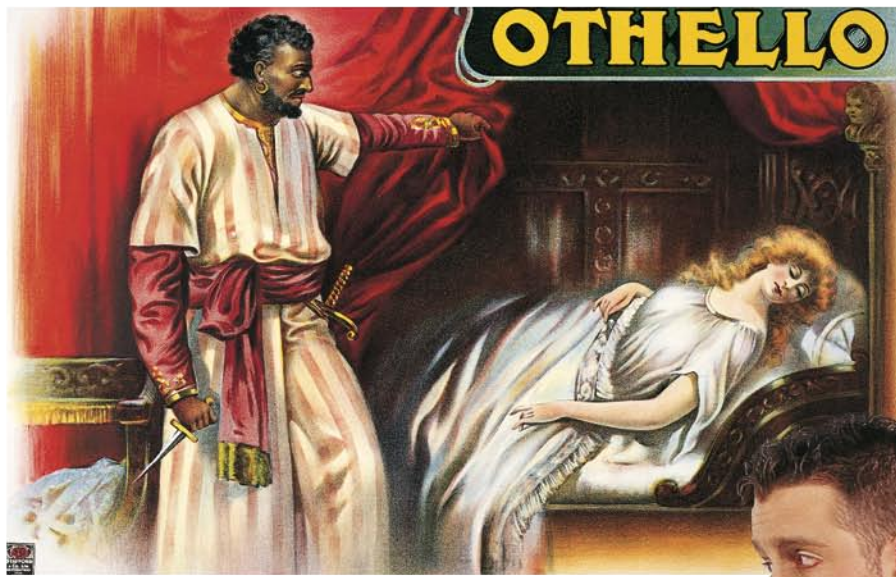




This poster advertising a production of *Othello* shows the Moor preparing to kill his sleeping wife Desdemona.

ROAST ME IN SULFUR!

The hero of *Othello* is a Moor (North African) married to Desdemona. Iago, the villain, secretly hates Othello and plots to destroy him. He makes Othello suspect that Desdemona is unfaithful. Driven insane by jealousy, Othello murders his innocent wife. Too late, he realizes that he has made a mistake. "Roast me in sulfur!" he cries. "Oh Desdemona! Desdemona dead!"



Iago

Othello

Iago is Shakespeare's greatest villain. He takes advantage of Othello's trusting nature. The Moor never suspects "honest Iago" as he calls him.

Fencers used a light, thin stabbing sword called a rapier



Hamlet gazes at his father's ghost, but his mother Gertrude cannot see the ghost, and thinks that her son is insane

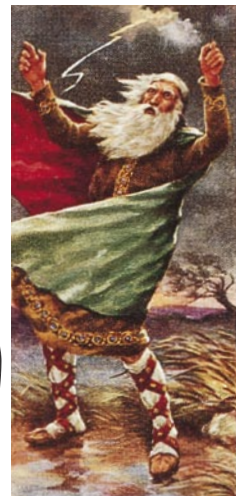
MOST UNNATURAL MURDER

In the 1947 film of the play *Hamlet*, Laurence Olivier played the prince. This is the tragedy of a Danish prince, ordered by the ghost of his father to avenge his "foul and most unnatural murder." He must kill the murderer who is both his uncle and his stepfather.

Hamlet is the most complex of Shakespeare's heroes



Polonius, Laertes's father, is accidentally killed by Hamlet, who mistakes him for the king.



FOOLISH FATHER

In the play *King Lear*, an old king foolishly divides his kingdom between two wicked daughters and rejects the daughter who loves him. Furious at his daughters' ingratitude, Lear takes to a storm-swept heath. He suffers madness, but eventually comes to understand how foolish he has been.

*"So shall you hear
Of carnal, bloody, and
unnatural acts,
Of accidental judgments,
casual slaughters."*

WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE
Horatio in *Hamlet*